Rebuttal to Argument in Favor

Measure N

Proponents call **Measure N** a "renewal." It is also a tax increase.

Clayton's existing landscape tax is $312.84 per residential parcel. **Measure N** raises it to $354.45 in 2027-28—an immediate 13.3% increase. Then the City Council may increase the tax with inflation by up to 3% every year through 2037. Maximum increases will likely be imposed, and the annual charge would reach about $462 by the final year, and a homeowner would pay more than $4,000 over the ten-year term.

The proponents describe a "one-time 10% reserve fee." But this is not a one-time payment. It is built into the higher tax base and can itself be increased in later years.

Nor does Clayton's own budget show an immediate landscape-maintenance crisis. The FY2027 adjusted budget projects about $1.362 million in LMD revenue against $1.386 million in expenditures—a difference of only $24,000—and an ending fund balance of roughly $252,000.

Clayton should justify the size of this increase, control costs, and offer voters a renewal closer to actual needs—not a 13% increase followed by authority for repeated increases.

This money would be better spent by property owners obtaining residential and commercial fire insurance at home. Inflation will continue, making it necessary for the City to join its residents in belt-tightening. Sooner is better to cut something less necessary.

Vote NO on Measure N.



Sandra Kallander

Chair, Libertarian Party of Contra Costa County

The undersigned author of the primary argument against Measure N at the General Election for the City of Clayton (in Contra Costa County) to be held on 11/3/26, hereby states that this argument is true and correct to the best of her knowledge and belief.

Sandra Kallander
Chair, Libertarian Party of Contra Costa County